DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador for the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The assignment is structured around five tasks, each mapping to a core module of the course. Together, these tasks cover the key pillars of digital literacy: creating visual communication, building a professional online identity, using coding and collaboration platforms, applying email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime and online safety.

Through this project, I worked entirely with free, browser-based tools — which reinforced the idea that digital literacy is accessible to everyone, regardless of their technical background. Each task was designed not as an isolated exercise, but as a practical skill I can carry forward throughout my four years of study and into my professional life. This report captures what I built, what I learned, and how each task challenged or changed my thinking about the digital world.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

What I Made and the Tool I Used

For Task 1, I created a one-page digital literacy infographic using Canva, a free, browser-based graphic design platform. Canva was the right choice for this task because it provides a large library of templates and icons that allowed me to focus on the content rather than spending time on raw design from scratch. The tool requires no installation and works entirely within a web browser, making it immediately accessible.

The infographic is titled 'Digital Literacy: Your Guide to Thriving Online' and is divided into five clearly labelled sections. The first section defines digital literacy as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies responsibly. The second highlights useful digital tools for students, including Google Drive, Canva itself, GitHub, and Google Classroom. The third covers safe internet practices, such as using strong passwords and enabling two-factor authentication. The fourth section explains the importance of maintaining a professional online presence on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub. The fifth and final section summarises email etiquette — covering subject lines, formal greetings, structured body text, and proper sign-offs.

The design uses a blue and white colour scheme for readability, with icons sourced from Canva's free library placed beside each section heading for visual clarity.

Reflection

The most interesting part of this task was recognising how broad digital literacy actually is. Before starting, I thought of it primarily as knowing how to use a computer — but building this infographic forced me to think across five different dimensions simultaneously: definitions, tools, safety, professional identity, and communication. Having to fit all of that into a single page was genuinely challenging. I created several early drafts that were too cluttered, and had to make deliberate choices about which information was essential and which could be left out. That process of prioritising and editing content was itself a form of digital communication practice, which I did not expect going in.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms I Set Up

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

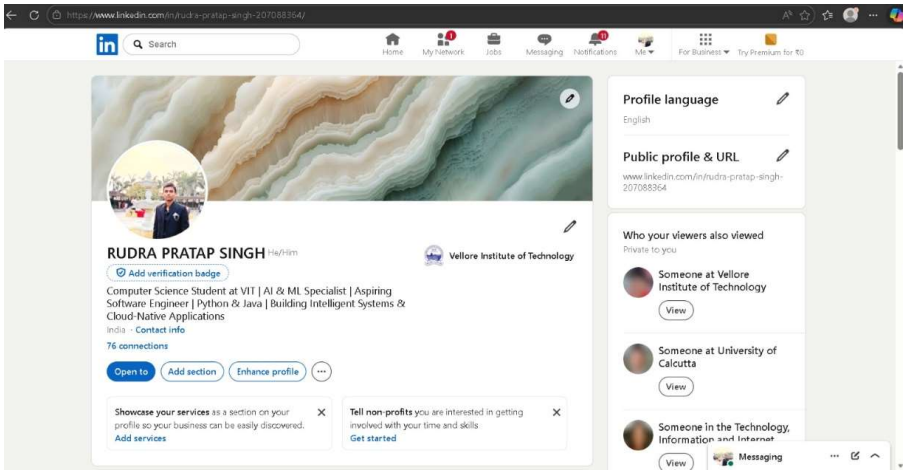
GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers and researchers worldwide. I created an account and set up a profile README — a special repository named after my username that appears at the top of my profile page. The README includes my name, registration number, branch (B.Tech AI & ML), year, and a short note about what I hope to learn during my degree.

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. I created a profile and filled in the Education section with my degree (B.Tech – Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year (2029). I kept the profile minimal and professional, as instructed.

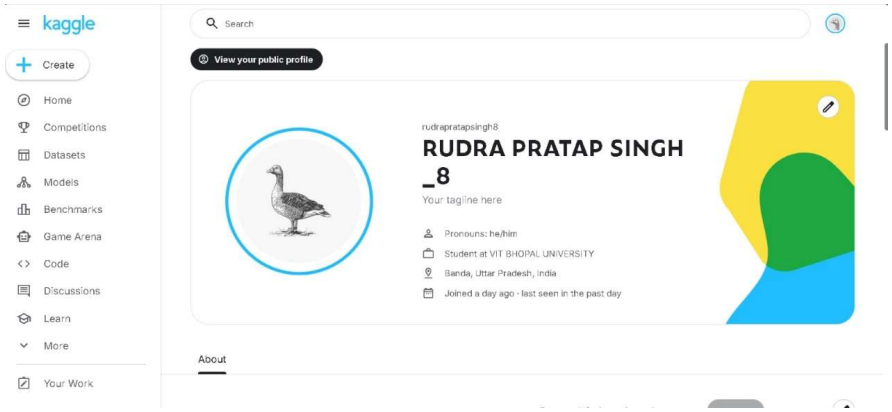
Kaggle is a platform specifically focused on data science, machine learning, and AI competitions. Given my branch, it is the most directly relevant platform for building domain-specific skills and showcasing data projects as I progress through my degree.

Screenshots

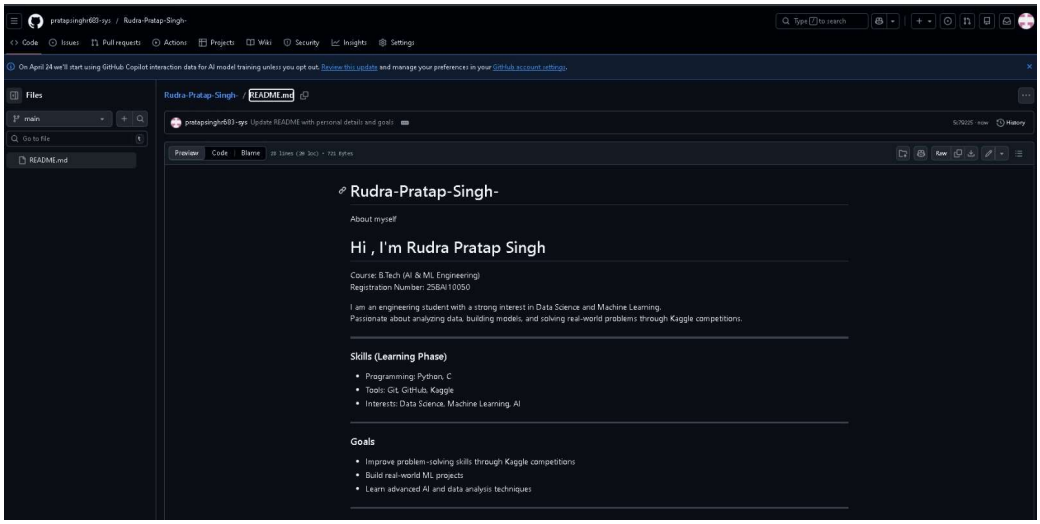
GitHub



Kaggle



LinkedIn



Reflection

Setting up these profiles was a more meaningful exercise than I initially expected. LinkedIn in particular made me think about how I want to present myself professionally — even at this early stage of my degree. The GitHub README was the most creative part: writing a few sentences about myself and my goals forced me to think about what I actually want to achieve in the next four years, not just what courses I am enrolled in.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all my coding projects and contribute to open-source repositories. LinkedIn will become more active in my second and third years when I begin applying for internships. Kaggle will be my practice ground for the AI and ML skills I learn in class — I intend to start with beginner datasets and gradually work toward entering competitions. Starting all three profiles early means I have a foundation that I can build on steadily, rather than rushing to create a presence at the last moment.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

HackerRank – Coding Practice

For Part A of Task 3, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the 'Solve Me First' challenge from the Algorithms track. HackerRank is a structured coding platform that organises problems by topic and difficulty level, and is used by major tech companies as part of their recruitment process.

The 'Solve Me First' challenge is an introductory problem that asks the user to write a function that returns the sum of two integers. While the logic is simple, the real learning was in navigating the HackerRank environment: understanding the code editor, reading the problem statement carefully, testing against sample inputs, and submitting. All test cases passed on the first attempt.

Google Forms – Digital Literacy Quiz

For Part B, I built a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz is designed to test first-year students on core digital literacy concepts in an accessible way. The form includes two multiple choice questions (on safe internet practices, UPI safety, and professional email formatting), two short answer questions (on the personal meaning of digital literacy and knowledge of cybercrime), and one question combining both formats.

Responses are automatically collected in a linked Google Sheet, which can be reviewed in real time. The form has been set to allow one response per user and has a progress bar enabled so respondents know how far along they are.

Reflection

These two tasks together showed me the two very different ways in which digital platforms support academic life. HackerRank is an individual, competitive tool — it trains you to think precisely and meet exact output specifications, which mirrors how professional software development actually works. Google Forms, by contrast, is a collaborative, communication-oriented tool. Building the quiz required me to think from the perspective of the respondent: are the questions clear? Are the options fair? Is the quiz actually educational, or is it just a test? That shift in perspective — from creator to user — is something I will carry into any future work involving digital communication or survey design.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Communication Scenario

For this task, I drafted two professional emails and created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist. The two emails — one to a professor and one to an internship coordinator — required me to apply real email etiquette in two different professional contexts. Drafting the email to the professor taught me how to be direct and respectful while making a sensitive request (asking for more time without sounding careless). Drafting the internship email was the more challenging of the two, because it required me to present myself positively while being honest about having limited experience.

A real-world example of poor digital communication that comes to mind is the case of an engineering student in a different college whose private WhatsApp messages criticising a faculty member were screenshotted and forwarded to the college administration. The student was disciplined, and the situation caused significant personal and professional embarrassment. What could have been done differently? The student could have raised the concern directly with the faculty member, or spoken to a student counsellor privately. Venting in a digital channel — even one you believe to be private — carries risk, because you lose control of who sees the content the moment you send it.

Key Learnings

The most important thing I learned from this task is that every email I send leaves a permanent record. Unlike a verbal conversation, a poorly written email can be forwarded, screenshotted, or reviewed months later. Investing thirty extra seconds in reading an email before sending — checking the subject line, the tone, and the sign-off — is a small habit that has a disproportionately large impact on how I am perceived professionally.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

What Surprised Me

I chose UPI/Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime topic because it is the most directly relevant to my daily life as a college student. I was aware that UPI fraud existed, but I did not fully understand the mechanics of how it worked until I researched it for this task. The most surprising thing I discovered is that the fraud does not require any hacking skill — it relies entirely on the victim's confusion about what a 'collect request' does. The fraudster simply sends a request that debits the victim's account and relies on the victim approving it without reading the transaction screen.

I was also surprised to learn that delaying a report to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or helpline 1930 by even a few hours significantly reduces the chance of fund recovery. Many students feel embarrassed after being scammed and wait before reporting — which is precisely what the fraudsters count on.

One Habit I Will Change

Going forward, I will always read the full UPI transaction screen before tapping 'Approve' — no matter how urgent the other person makes it seem. Urgency is itself a red flag, not a reason to act faster. I will also save the number 1930 in my contacts as 'Cyber Crime Helpline' so that I can access it immediately if I or a friend ever needs it. Digital safety is not just an awareness exercise — it requires building small, deliberate habits that become automatic over time.

Conclusion

This project was a genuinely useful introduction to what it means to be digitally literate in 2025. Each of the five tasks addressed a different layer of digital life — visual communication, professional identity, platform literacy, written communication, and personal safety. The most significant overall learning is that digital literacy is not a single skill; it is a set of interconnected habits and competencies that reinforce each other. A student who builds a clean GitHub profile, writes professional emails, stays safe online, and knows how to report a cybercrime is not doing five separate things — they are developing a single, coherent capacity to operate effectively and safely in the digital world. I leave this project with practical profiles set up, real documents drafted, and a better understanding of the risks and opportunities that the digital world presents.

References

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- Google Forms – https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Reserve Bank of India – Consumer Awareness on UPI Fraud (2023)
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) – UPI Safety Guidelines